

Maisarah WIZAN

Career profile

While I have a passion for and background in applied economics, I enjoy working in a multidisciplinary setting and learning about novel and mixed methodologies. In my work, I employ methods and perspectives across economics, sociology, as well as social and public policy.

Research interests: Applied econometrics | Labour economics | Social policy | Social epidemiology

Education

- May 22–Sep 26 **PhD in Social and Economic Sciences**, *Herman Deleeck Centre for Social Policy, University of Antwerp*, Antwerp
Defended on: 14 September 2026
Visiting Researcher at Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research (LISER), April–May, 2025.
- Sep 20–Sep 21 **M.Sc. in Development Studies (Advanced Master's)**, *Institute of Development Policy (IOB), University of Antwerp*, Antwerp, *Great Distinction*
Interdisciplinary programme within the field of development studies
- Feb 19–Jun 19 **Bachelor's Exchange Programme**, *Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Antwerp*, Antwerp
Some courses were also taken at the Faculty of Social Sciences. Enrolled for five courses (30 ECTS) in total, including two courses at Master's level:
 - 'Public Finance (2109TEWECP)'
 - 'Political Economy of Development (2200FSWEID)'
- Aug 16–Jun 20 **B.Sc. (Honours) in Economics**, *National University of Singapore (NUS)*, Singapore, *Distinction (GPA: 4.37/5.00)*
Specialisation in Applied and Policy Economics
Minor in European Studies
Graduate and postgraduate courses taken during honours year (i.e., optional additional year to complete independent research):
 - 'Policy Impact Evaluation Methods (EC5326R)' – applied econometrics
 - 'Macroeconomic Analysis III (EC4302)' – inter-temporal optimisation models

Working Papers

Wizan, M. (2026). Lower Pay and Less Stable? Understanding the Migrant-Native Volatility Gap in Earnings. Unpublished manuscript (submission in preparation; available on request).

Wizan, M., Sologon, D.M. & Marchal, S. (2025). The Shift from Persistent Inequality to Earnings Instability in Belgium: A Longitudinal Decomposition by Gender and Education using Administrative Records, 2005–2021. IZA Discussion Paper No. 18132. Under review (Revise & Resubmit) at *Labour Economics*.

<https://www.iza.org/publications/dp/18132>

Publications

Wizan, M. & Marchal, S. (2026). Balancing Timeliness, Efficiency and Effectiveness: An Assessment of Targeted Social Policies in Challenging Times. *Social Policy & Administration*, 60, no. 1: 193–207.
<https://doi.org/10.1111/spol.13156>

Doctoral Thesis

- Title *Socio-demographic Patterns of Instability: Essays on earnings and income volatility in Belgium*
- Supervisor Prof. dr. Sarah Marchal
- Institute Herman Deleeck Centre for Social Policy, University of Antwerp
- Jury Prof. dr. Ive Marx (UAntwerpen, chair), Prof. dr. Sunčica Vujić (UAntwerpen), Dr. Denisa Sologon (LISER), Prof. dr. Philippe Van Kerm (LISER, University of Luxembourg), Prof. dr. Stephen Jenkins (LSE)
- Description The thesis investigates the evolution of earnings and income volatility in Belgium, with a focus on its socio-demographic determinants as well as how the design of social policies impact volatility. This empirical work makes use of large-scale administrative panel data (e.g., IPCAL tax data, demographic data from DEMOBEL, census data) using parametric (e.g., error components models) and non-parametric methods. Additionally, microsimulation and nowcasting techniques were used to create an intra-year dataset using survey and administrative data for the evaluation of social policy responses to the COVID-19 pandemic. A copy of the thesis is available from the university's repository.

Master's Thesis

- Title *Half-Earth, Conservation and New Media: An analysis of NGO narratives using the Narrative Policy Framework*
- Supervisor Prof. dr. Gert Van Hecken [🔗](#)
- Institute Institute of Development Policy, University of Antwerp
- Grade 17/20
- Description The thesis explores how social media can be used in the construction of narratives about the 'Half-Earth' – the idea to conserve half of Earth's landmass by 2030. A mixed method approach, following the Narrative Policy Framework, is used on scraped Twitter data collected from various non-governmental organisations, who hold contesting notions about conservation. This thesis received a valorisation grant.

Bachelor's Thesis

- Title *A Student Fixed Effects Approach: Does computer use in classrooms improve test scores?*
- Supervisor Prof. dr. Nina Guyon [🔗](#)
- Institute Department of Economics, National University of Singapore
- Grade A+ (~20/20)
- Description The thesis was written independently as part of the graduation requirements of the optional Honours' year. Using a student fixed effects model, alongside Oster's (2019) method in determining the extent of selection bias, the thesis investigates the causal effects of classroom computer use on test scores. (Full abstract [🔗](#)).

Conferences and Presentations

- Jan 26 | Organising Committee, Speaker AIPRIL/CHANGE Workshop "Changing work, changing incomes: assessing the vulnerability of non-standard workers and self employed", *University of Antwerp*
- “Earnings volatility and dynamics: the migrant-native volatility gap in Belgium”
- Sep 25 | Speaker Annual European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR) Conference: Demography and Social Inequality, *University of Cologne*
- “Long-run inequality and instability in earnings in Belgium: the role of education and gender”

- Apr 25 | Speaker HEC Liège Young Researchers Conference in Economics, *HEC Liège*
 "Long-run inequality and instability in earnings over the lifecycle in Belgium, 2005-2021"
- May 23 | Speaker 1st Welfare & Policy Conference, *Bordeaux School of Economics*
 "Balancing speed and effectiveness: Smoothing income volatility through COVID-19 social policy responses in Belgium"
- Aug 22 | Participant International Association for Research in Income and Wealth (IARIW) 37th General Conference, *Luxembourg*

Training and Workshops

- Oct, Nov 22 EUROMOD Autumn Training & BELMOD Autumn Course
 Courses and workshops in microsimulation
- Aug-Sep 22 FLAMES Summer School
 Longitudinal and Incomplete Data
 Time Series Analysis
 Essentials of R

Awards and Achievements

- 2022 **Master's Thesis Valorisation Grant**
 Amount: 1000€
 Awarded to graduate students with dissertations of high quality for the valorisation of their thesis.
- 2020 **NUS Dean's Scholars List**, *Academic Year 2019-2020, Semester 2*
 Amount: 100 SGD (66€)
 Placed on the Dean's Scholars List for academic achievement, which recognises the top 1% of the faculty cohort of around 6000 students. [🔗](#)
- 2019 **NUS Alumni Student Exchange Award**, *Academic Year 2018-2019*
 Amount: 2500 SGD (1657€)
 Awarded to students embarking on a semester abroad who have shown great involvement in co-curricular activities.

Languages

English	Native	Malay	Native
Bahasa Indonesia	Proficient (C1)	German	Intermediate (B1+) 🔗
Spanish	Elementary (A2)	Dutch	Intermediate (B1) 🔗

Computer skills

Software and programming	Stata (Proficient), R (Proficient), $\text{\LaTeX}$ (Proficient), NVivo (Intermediate), MATLAB (Basic), SPSS (Basic), SAS (Basic), Python (Basic), Excel VBA (Basic)
Miscellaneous	EUROMOD (Intermediate), Git (Basic)
Microsoft Office Suite	Excel, PowerPoint, Word (Proficient)